SEO Audit Report — shop.example.com

DATA LABEL: SYNTHETIC — this report was not produced from a live crawl of the named website and must not be presented as real observations.

Start URL	https://shop.example.com/
Audit status	completed
Started (UTC)	2026-10-28T13:38:26+00:00
Finished (UTC)	2026-10-28T13:38:26+00:00
Pages analysed	6
Additional URLs link-checked	0
Total findings	27
Health score (heuristic)	37.7 / 100
Crawl limits	max 30 pages, depth 3
robots.txt	HTTP 200
Sitemap	https://shop.example.com/sitemap.xml → found

Findings by severity

Critical	High	Medium	Low	Info
1	4	6	15	1

Prioritised action plan

#	Issue	Severity	Pages	Effort	Priority	Fix
1	Broken internal link	critical	2	low	100.0	Update or remove the broken links on the linking pages, or redirect the broken URL to a relevant live page.
2	Missing title tag	high	1	low	75.0	Add a unique, descriptive <title> (roughly 30–60 characters) that includes the page's main topic.
3	Redirect loop or excessive redirects	high	1	medium	60.0	Fix the redirect rules so the URL resolves to a single final page in one hop.
4	Redirect chain	medium	1	low	50.0	Point the first URL (and any internal links to it) directly at the final destination with a single 301 redirect.
5	Insecure (HTTP) resources on HTTPS page	medium	1	low	42.5	Load these resources over HTTPS (or use protocol-relative/relative URLs).
6	Missing viewport meta tag	medium	1	low	42.5	Add <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1">.
7	Images missing alt attribute	medium	1	medium	38.0	Add descriptive alt text to meaningful images, and alt="" to purely decorative ones.
8	Page is set to noindex	high	1	low	36.0	If the page should rank, remove 'noindex' from the robots meta tag / X-Robots-Tag header. If intentional, no action is needed.
9	Missing H1 heading	medium	1	low	36.0	Add one visible <h1> that states the page's main topic.
10	Missing meta description	medium	1	low	36.0	Add a unique meta description (roughly 50–160 characters) summarising the page and its value.
11	Duplicate meta description across pages	low	4	low	28.5	Write a distinct description for each page.
12	Missing canonical tag	low	1	low	18.0	Add a self-referencing <link rel="canonical"> with the preferred absolute URL.
13	Internal links point to redirecting URLs	low	1	low	18.0	Update the internal links to point directly at the final URL.
14	Missing html lang attribute	low	1	low	16.0	Add the page language, e.g. <html lang="en">.
15	Skipped heading level	low	1	low	14.0	Use heading levels in order (H1 → H2 → H3) to reflect the content outline.

#	Issue	Severity	Pages	Effort	Priority	Fix
16	Title may be truncated in results	low	1	low	12.0	Move the most important words to the front and aim for roughly 30–60 characters.
17	Meta description length outside typical range	low	2	low	11.7	Aim for roughly 50–160 characters with the key message first.
18	Multiple H1 headings	low	1	low	10.0	Consider keeping one H1 for the main topic and using H2/H3 for sections.
19	Very short title	low	1	low	10.0	Expand the title to describe the page's topic (and brand, if useful).
20	Low word count	low	2	medium	7.5	Check whether the page fully answers its visitors' needs; add useful content if it does not.
21	Internal URLs blocked by robots.txt	info	1	low	5.0	Confirm that each blocked path is meant to be hidden from crawlers; unblock any that should be indexed.

Findings with evidence (top 27 of 27 by priority)

CRITICAL · **Broken internal link** · priority 95.0 · defect

URL: https://shop.example.com/error

Evidence: https://shop.example.com/error returned HTTP 500. Linked from 1 page(s), anchor text "Status": https://shop.example.com/

Why: One or more pages link to an internal URL that returned an error status.

Fix: Update or remove the broken links on the linking pages, or redirect the broken URL to a relevant live page.

Effort: low · Confidence: 95% · Rule: BROKEN_INTERNAL_LINK

HIGH · **Missing title tag** · priority 75.0 · defect

URL: https://shop.example.com/contact

Evidence: No <title> element found in the HTML <head>.

Why: The page has no <title> element. Titles are a primary source for the clickable headline in search results.

Fix: Add a unique, descriptive <title> (roughly 30–60 characters) that includes the page's main topic.

Effort: low · Confidence: 100% · Rule: TITLE_MISSING

HIGH · **Broken internal link** · priority 71.2 · defect

URL: https://shop.example.com/missing

Evidence: https://shop.example.com/missing returned HTTP 404. Linked from 2 page(s), anchor text "Gift cards": https://shop.example.com/, https://shop.example.com/blog

Why: One or more pages link to an internal URL that returned an error status.

Fix: Update or remove the broken links on the linking pages, or redirect the broken URL to a relevant live page.

Effort: low · Confidence: 95% · Rule: BROKEN_INTERNAL_LINK

HIGH · **Redirect loop or excessive redirects** · priority 60.0 · defect

URL: https://shop.example.com/loop-a

Evidence: Redirect loop detected. Hops: https://shop.example.com/loop-a → https://shop.example.com/loop-b

Why: The URL redirects in a loop or exceeds the redirect limit, so it never resolves to a page.

Fix: Fix the redirect rules so the URL resolves to a single final page in one hop.

Effort: medium · Confidence: 100% · Rule: REDIRECT_LOOP

MEDIUM · **Redirect chain** · priority 50.0 · defect

URL: https://shop.example.com/old-page

Evidence: 2 redirects: https://shop.example.com/old-page (301) → https://shop.example.com/redirect-mid (301) → https://shop.example.com/about (200)

Why: The URL passes through two or more redirects before reaching the final page. Chains slow users down and waste crawl budget.

Fix: Point the first URL (and any internal links to it) directly at the final destination with a single 301 redirect.

Effort: low · Confidence: 100% · Rule: REDIRECT_CHAIN

MEDIUM · **Insecure (HTTP) resources on HTTPS page** · priority 42.5 · defect

URL: https://shop.example.com/products

Evidence: 1 insecure resource(s), e.g. http://cdn.example.net/bowl.jpg

Why: This HTTPS page loads images, scripts, stylesheets or frames over plain HTTP. Browsers may block them or show warnings.

Fix: Load these resources over HTTPS (or use protocol-relative/relative URLs).

Effort: low · Confidence: 85% · Rule: MIXED_CONTENT

MEDIUM · **Missing viewport meta tag** · priority 42.5 · defect

URL: https://shop.example.com/contact

Evidence: No <meta name="viewport"> tag found.

Why: No <meta name="viewport"> was found, so mobile browsers may render the page at desktop width.

Fix: Add <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1">.

Effort: low · Confidence: 85% · Rule: VIEWPORT_MISSING

MEDIUM · **Images missing alt attribute** · priority 38.0 · defect

URL: https://shop.example.com/about

Evidence: 1 of 2 images have no alt attribute. Examples: https://shop.example.com/img/team.jpg

Why: Some <img> elements have no alt attribute at all. Alt text is needed for screen readers and helps image search. (Empty alt="" is correct for decorative images and is not flagged.)

Fix: Add descriptive alt text to meaningful images, and alt="" to purely decorative ones.

Effort: medium · Confidence: 95% · Rule: IMG_ALT_MISSING

HIGH · **Page is set to noindex** · priority 36.0 · recommendation

URL: https://shop.example.com/contact

Evidence: X-Robots-Tag: noindex

Why: A robots meta tag or X-Robots-Tag header tells search engines not to index this page. If unintentional, the page cannot appear in search results.

Fix: If the page should rank, remove 'noindex' from the robots meta tag / X-Robots-Tag header. If intentional, no action is needed.

Effort: low · Confidence: 60% · Rule: NOINDEX

MEDIUM · **Missing H1 heading** · priority 36.0 · recommendation

URL: https://shop.example.com/about

Evidence: No <h1> element found in the HTML.

Why: No <h1> was found in the HTML. A clear main heading helps users and search engines understand the page topic. (Content rendered only by JavaScript is not visible to this crawler.)

Fix: Add one visible <h1> that states the page's main topic.

Effort: low · Confidence: 90% · Rule: H1_MISSING

MEDIUM · **Missing meta description** · priority 36.0 · recommendation

URL: https://shop.example.com/about

Evidence: No <meta name="description"> tag found.

Why: No meta description was found. Search engines may generate a snippet from page text instead; a written description gives you more control over the snippet.

Fix: Add a unique meta description (roughly 50–160 characters) summarising the page and its value.

Effort: low · Confidence: 90% · Rule: META_DESC_MISSING

LOW · **Duplicate meta description across pages** · priority 21.2 · defect

URL: https://shop.example.com/

Evidence: "Handmade ceramics and homeware, designed in small batches and shipped worldwide from our studio." is shared by 2 pages: https://shop.example.com/, https://shop.example.com/contact

Why: Several crawled pages share exactly the same meta description.

Fix: Write a distinct description for each page.

Effort: low · Confidence: 85% · Rule: META_DESC_DUPLICATE

LOW · **Duplicate meta description across pages** · priority 21.2 · defect

URL: https://shop.example.com/blog

Evidence: "Browse our full range." is shared by 2 pages: https://shop.example.com/products, https://shop.example.com/blog

Why: Several crawled pages share exactly the same meta description.

Fix: Write a distinct description for each page.

Effort: low · Confidence: 85% · Rule: META_DESC_DUPLICATE

LOW · **Duplicate meta description across pages** · priority 21.2 · defect

URL: https://shop.example.com/contact

Evidence: "Handmade ceramics and homeware, designed in small batches and shipped worldwide from our studio." is shared by 2 pages: https://shop.example.com/, https://shop.example.com/contact

Why: Several crawled pages share exactly the same meta description.

Fix: Write a distinct description for each page.

Effort: low · Confidence: 85% · Rule: META_DESC_DUPLICATE

LOW · **Duplicate meta description across pages** · priority 21.2 · defect

URL: https://shop.example.com/products

Evidence: "Browse our full range." is shared by 2 pages: https://shop.example.com/products, https://shop.example.com/blog

Why: Several crawled pages share exactly the same meta description.

Fix: Write a distinct description for each page.

Effort: low · Confidence: 85% · Rule: META_DESC_DUPLICATE

LOW · **Missing canonical tag** · priority 18.0 · recommendation

URL: https://shop.example.com/about

Evidence: No <link rel="canonical"> found.

Why: No rel="canonical" link was found. Canonicals help consolidate duplicate URLs (e.g. with tracking parameters).

Fix: Add a self-referencing <link rel="canonical"> with the preferred absolute URL.

Effort: low · Confidence: 90% · Rule: CANONICAL_MISSING

LOW · **Internal links point to redirecting URLs** · priority 18.0 · recommendation

URL: https://shop.example.com/old-page

Evidence: https://shop.example.com/old-page redirects (301) to https://shop.example.com/about. Linked from 1 page(s): https://shop.example.com/

Why: Internal links point to a URL that redirects. It works, but costs an extra request for every visit and crawl.

Fix: Update the internal links to point directly at the final URL.

Effort: low · Confidence: 90% · Rule: LINK_TO_REDIRECT

LOW · **Missing html lang attribute** · priority 16.0 · recommendation

URL: https://shop.example.com/contact

Evidence: <html> element has no lang attribute.

Why: The <html> element has no lang attribute, which helps screen readers and language detection.

Fix: Add the page language, e.g. <html lang="en">.

Effort: low · Confidence: 80% · Rule: LANG_MISSING

LOW · **Skipped heading level** · priority 14.0 · recommendation

URL: https://shop.example.com/products

Evidence: H2 "Bowls" is followed by H4 "Large bowls".

Why: The heading hierarchy skips a level (for example an H2 followed directly by an H4). This mainly affects accessibility and document structure.

Fix: Use heading levels in order (H1 → H2 → H3) to reflect the content outline.

Effort: low · Confidence: 70% · Rule: HEADING_SKIP

LOW · **Title may be truncated in results** · priority 12.0 · recommendation

URL: https://shop.example.com/blog

Evidence: Title (98 chars): "The Example Shop Journal: Stories, Studio Notes, Glazing Experiments and Behind-the-Scenes Updates"

Why: The title is longer than 60 characters. Search engines truncate by pixel width, so this is an approximation, not a hard limit.

Fix: Move the most important words to the front and aim for roughly 30–60 characters.

Effort: low · Confidence: 60% · Rule: TITLE_TOO_LONG

LOW · **Multiple H1 headings** · priority 10.0 · recommendation

URL: https://shop.example.com/blog

Evidence: 2 H1 headings: "Journal"; "Latest posts"

Why: The page has more than one <h1>. This is valid HTML and not a confirmed problem, but a single main heading usually gives a clearer structure.

Fix: Consider keeping one H1 for the main topic and using H2/H3 for sections.

Effort: low · Confidence: 50% · Rule: H1_MULTIPLE

LOW · **Meta description length outside typical range** · priority 10.0 · recommendation

URL: https://shop.example.com/blog

Evidence: Meta description (22 chars): "Browse our full range."

Why: The description is outside the commonly displayed range of about 50–160 characters. This is guidance only; snippet length varies.

Fix: Aim for roughly 50–160 characters with the key message first.

Effort: low · Confidence: 50% · Rule: META_DESC_LENGTH

LOW · **Meta description length outside typical range** · priority 10.0 · recommendation

URL: https://shop.example.com/products

Evidence: Meta description (22 chars): "Browse our full range."

Why: The description is outside the commonly displayed range of about 50–160 characters. This is guidance only; snippet length varies.

Fix: Aim for roughly 50–160 characters with the key message first.

Effort: low · Confidence: 50% · Rule: META_DESC_LENGTH

LOW · **Very short title** · priority 10.0 · recommendation

URL: https://shop.example.com/about

Evidence: Title (4 chars): "Shop"

Why: The title is shorter than 15 characters, which may not describe the page well.

Fix: Expand the title to describe the page's topic (and brand, if useful).

Effort: low · Confidence: 50% · Rule: TITLE_TOO_SHORT

LOW · **Low word count** · priority 6.4 · recommendation

URL: https://shop.example.com/about

Evidence: 5 words of visible text found in the HTML.

Why: Fewer than 150 words of text were found in the HTML. Word count is not a ranking factor by itself, and pages rendered with JavaScript may appear thin to this crawler.

Fix: Check whether the page fully answers its visitors' needs; add useful content if it does not.

Effort: medium · Confidence: 40% · Rule: THIN_CONTENT

LOW · **Low word count** · priority 6.4 · recommendation

URL: https://shop.example.com/contact

Evidence: 3 words of visible text found in the HTML.

Why: Fewer than 150 words of text were found in the HTML. Word count is not a ranking factor by itself, and pages rendered with JavaScript may appear thin to this crawler.

Fix: Check whether the page fully answers its visitors' needs; add useful content if it does not.

Effort: medium · Confidence: 40% · Rule: THIN_CONTENT

INFO · **Internal URLs blocked by robots.txt** · priority 5.0 · informational

URL: https://shop.example.com/

Evidence: 1 internal URL(s) disallowed, e.g. https://shop.example.com/admin/login

Why: Some internal links point to URLs disallowed by robots.txt. These were not crawled. This is often intentional (e.g. cart or admin pages).

Fix: Confirm that each blocked path is meant to be hidden from crawlers; unblock any that should be indexed.

Effort: low · Confidence: 100% · Rule: ROBOTS_BLOCKED

Scope and limitations

• SYNTHETIC DEMO: shop.example.com is a fictional fixture website served from memory. These findings are genuine crawler output for that fixture, not observations of any real company.

• Only raw HTML is analysed; JavaScript is never executed, so content rendered client-side may be missed.

• robots.txt is always respected; disallowed URLs are not crawled.

• Only pages on the same host as the start URL ('www.' treated as equivalent) are crawled.

• Severity, priority and health scores are transparent heuristics, not Google metrics or ranking factors.

• Length thresholds for titles and descriptions are approximations; search engines truncate by pixel width.

• Pages behind logins, paywalls or bot protection are not accessed; such pages may appear as errors.

• Results reflect a single point in time; transient server errors can appear and should be re-tested.

Scoring: priority = 100 × severity weight × impact × confidence × effort factor. See docs/SCORING.md. Scores are heuristics, not official search-engine metrics.